The cell is the basic unit of life. Every living thing is made of one cell or of many cells. Inside the cell is a nucleus that holds the genetic material.

The cell membrane protects the inner environment. It lets water and some substances pass, and blocks others.

Mitochondria produce energy for the cell. Muscle cells contain especially many mitochondria, because they use a lot of energy.

Plant cells also have a rigid cell wall and chloroplasts. Photosynthesis happens in the chloroplasts, where light becomes sugar.